



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ireland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that — you're at an important crossroads, and it's great that you're thinking about your options. Since you're 16 and have just completed primary school in Denmark (likely **Folkeskole**, assuming you mean the 9th or 10th grade), there are a few good educational paths ahead, depending on your interests, learning style, and future goals.

## 🇩🇰 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

If you're interested in going to **university** in the future or want a broader academic education, these are strong choices:

### ♦ STX – Alment Gymnasium

- General academic upper secondary education.
- Covers humanities, sciences, and social studies.
- Ideal if you're not sure exactly what you want to study later.

### ♦ HHX – Higher Commercial Examination Programme

- Focuses on business, economics, and languages.
- Good if you're interested in international business or entrepreneurship.

### ♦ HTX – Higher Technical Examination Programme

- Focuses on technology, natural sciences, and innovation.
- Great for engineering, science, or tech-related careers.

### ♦ HF – Higher Preparatory Examination

- Shorter (2 years instead of 3), more flexible.
- Often chosen by students who want to go to university but prefer a more practical or less traditional academic path.

## 🔧 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – VET)

If you like **hands-on learning** and want to start working sooner (with the option of higher education later), this is a great path:

- Combines school and apprenticeship (praktik).

- Leads to skilled trades or technical jobs (e.g. electrician, carpenter, chef, social care).
- Can be a stepping stone to **EUX** — a combined vocational and academic path that also qualifies you for university.

### 3. International or English-language options

Given your Irish background and fluency in Danish, you might also consider:

- **International Baccalaureate (IB)** at an international school or a gymnasium that offers it.
  - Taught in English.
  - Highly recognized worldwide.
  - Prepares well for international university studies (including in Ireland or other countries).

### How to Choose?

Ask yourself:

- **Do you prefer academic or practical learning?**
- **Do you want to work soon or study longer?**
- **Are you more interested in science, arts, business, or technical subjects?**
- **Would you like to study or work abroad someday?**

### BONUS: Irish Connection

If you're considering **studying in Ireland later**, then:

- Doing an **IB** or **STX** can keep doors open.
- Irish/EU citizens (you likely are one, via your parents) often qualify for reduced university fees in Ireland.
- Having strong Danish and English is a huge advantage.

### Final Thoughts

Here's a simple breakdown:

| If you want to...                     | Then consider... |
|---------------------------------------|------------------|
| Keep your options open                | STX or IB        |
| Focus on business & economy           | HHX              |
| Get technical or engineering skills   | HTX              |
| Work sooner with practical experience | VET or EUX       |
| Finish fast and go to uni             | HF               |

Would you like help narrowing this down based on your interests or career ideas?